



WITH BOTH PARTNERS EARNING, STEREOTYPICAL NOTIONS SHATTER. THEY MAY EVEN HAVE DIFFERENT ACCOUNTS FOR WHEN THEY ARE NOT TOGETHER.

Bansal: In traditional households, the men buy jewellery, not as a consumption item but as an investment.

Nakhate: Both men and women spend. What is different is what they spend on. While a woman would invest in jewellery, a man would splurge on a big car. For a woman, a car is only important because she's comfortable in it. The make doesn't really matter.

In a single-income household a man takes the investment decisions while the woman looks after day-to-day expenditure. Does this change when both members earn? Are men still the planners or do they take joint financial decisions?

Nakhate: It depends on how much you value the other person's decision. There will be consultative decisions where you will involve the partner, for example, in deciding retirement options. However, there will be other times when one partner is better equipped to take a decision.

Tandon: If both decide to invest in equity then they will discuss it. Of course, both will have different views and might arrive at a consensus or do their separate thing. That said, knowing how couples function, after six months of investing they will share notes and rib each other about the



mistakes. Success might not be measured but failure certainly will be—in jest, not acrimony.

Bansal: They not only discuss investments made, but also investments foregone. In Mumbai, for instance, everyone will talk about the flat they should have bought three years ago.

Roy: With both partners earning, all stereotypical notions are shattered. I know of many dual-income households where both men and women have completely different accounts

because they are actually planning for the day when they're not together.

Gupta: There are surveys to prove that when men are asked if they know about investment decisions, most will say yes. But when women are asked the same thing, very few answer in the affirmative. This depends entirely on education, socio-economic status and awareness.

Do men and women complement each other when it comes to financial decisions?

Bansal: If the woman in the family is a banker and the man runs a small business enterprise, the woman may have more knowledge. One would assume that there will be discussion before taking a decision. The same

holds true if the situation is reversed.

Tandon: I'm from the financial services sector and am expected to have a more informed view on investments and property prices. So if a decision needs to be taken, my wife does take a backseat.

Nakhate: It's important to take joint decisions. It's a chance for the two to spend time together. They also avoid future battles and don't blame each other for a wrong choice.

How much of your professional specialisation comes to the rescue when it comes to investing for your own family?

Nakhate: Because I am in investment banking, I take back to the family what we could do with finances. It's not necessary that we agree. My husband might come up with a better idea after consulting the financial advisor.

Roy: I come from a single-income household, so what I take to the house is whatever happens on the outside. What happens inside remains my wife's purview.

Bansal: Since my husband and I come from fairly similar professional backgrounds, our expectations are reasonably similar. We are both pretty aggressive about how we want to manage our finances.